Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q J 9 7 6 5
♥ Q 10 2
♦ 7
♣ 6 3

♠ 10 3
♥ 8 7 4
♦ Q J 10 8 6
♣ A 10 4

♠ 8 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ A K 5 3
♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 4
♥ K J 5
♦ 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

NORTH has a 7-card ♠ suit but he is too strong to open with a preemptive bid. So he opens 1♠ instead.

SOUTH should respond 2♣, and NORTH can do nothing but rebid the ♠ suit.

SOUTH thinks there should be game and bids 4♠

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8
♥ 10 6 5
♦ J 10 8
♣ 10 9 8 7 3

♠ K Q
♥ Q J
♦ A K Q 6 5
♣ K J 4 2

♠ 7 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 4 3
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 5

♠ J 10 9 5 3 2
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ A 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠J

EAST is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! WEST has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose EAST has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then EAST couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So WEST just bids 4♥.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 5
♥ 4
♦ K Q 9 4
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 10 9 8 3
♦ A 10 3
♣ 10 3

♠ K 6 4 2
♥ 5
♦ J 7 6 2
♣ A Q 9 6

♠ J 8 3
♥ K Q J 7 6 2
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
All Pass			

2♥ by South
Lead: ♣10

NORTH really hates that 2♥ opening by SOUTH.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 9
♥ J 9 3
♦ Q J 7 3
♣ A Q 10 8 4

♠ A Q J 10 6 5
♥ 7
♦ A 9 5
♣ K J 3

♠ K 8 4
♥ A Q 10 6 4 2
♦ 4
♣ 9 6 5

♠ 7 3 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ K 10 8 6 2
♣ 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♠9

WEST expects to be better off in ♠s than EAST would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, EAST should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. WEST then bids the ♠ game.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4 ♦ 6 3 2 ♣ 8 4	
♠ 9 4 2 ♥ 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2	N W E S	♠ Q J 10 8 3 ♥ 10 9 ♦ A 8 ♣ K J 10 7
	♠ A K 7 5 ♥ K 6 3 ♦ K Q J 5 4 ♣ A	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠Q

NORTH has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

SOUTH, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH can bid 6♥ with confidence.